

United Overseas Bank (UOB)

Downgrading to UW as rally opens up downside to PT

UOB is up 13% YTD vs. 4/8/5% for DBS, OCBC and STI. The rally came on the back of expectations of q/q improvement in 4Q; post a spike in provisions in 3Q. We broadly concurred with the short-term view, which along with low valuations led us to upgrade the stock in Nov-25 ([link](#)). Yet, we do not see AQ issues fully cleared in 4Q25, even if the quarter appears closer to BAU. Accordingly, we expect negative consensus revisions in 2026 (JPM is 4% below Street), leading to de-rating of the stock. The key risks stem from HK CRE portfolio, as well as consistent high credit costs in TH; as has been the 2026 guidance from large TH banks last week. US CRE risk as well as tighter liquidity in Indonesia are further potential drivers of earnings risk. We are not changing our estimates and PT. Our pecking order in the industry now is DBS (OW) > OCBC (N) > UOB (UW).

Valuations/AQ/RoE: UOB is close to 5Y highs on fwd PB/PE at 1.3x/11.9x, ~1.5-2SD above mean. Yet, we expect RoE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25, when the PB had moved to ~1.3x. If anything, risks to 1H26 RoEs are high, as lower credit costs are not necessarily a given. The timing of gross NPL formation, recoveries and upgrades, as well as evolution of collateral values should lead to volatility on credit costs and expectations thereof. Moreover, at any point if the LLR/loans drops below 1%, de-rating will follow as investors will price in higher provisions going forward. We see more balanced risk-return trade-off closer to 1-1.1 fwd PB (mean), which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.

Key AQ metrics: Gross NPA formation in 3Q25 was S\$838mn (97bps, ann) vs. the S\$400mn avg in previous 4Qs (47bps, ann). Net NPA formation in 3Q25 was S\$423mn (49bps, ann) vs. the S\$109mn avg in previous 4Qs (13bps, ann). This recognition of higher gross NPA and accelerated upgrades, recoveries and write-offs are based on the bank's best estimate of economic risks as of 3Q. Looking at details, GC NPAs are up S\$508mn y/y (+51% y/y), led mostly by HK CRE; and RoW NPAs are up S\$469mn y/y (+105% y/y), led by US CRE. On HK CRE, our colleagues (Karl Chan and team) have an informative deep dive ([here](#)), where trends do not bode well for UOB credit costs.

Sector view: Capital generation and distribution should drive differentiation across SG banks; with consistent flows (led by S\$ appeal and WM) leading to a positive bias. Yet, dividend yield will not be as dominant a factor as the last 2Y. Expect EPS and DPS revisions, USD/SGD rate moves, AQ and buybacks to drive 2026 performance. DBS stays our top pick on high visibility on capital generation (highest RoE even after 310bps SORA decline), led by WM, tech-led franchise, RoRWA focus and capital management. The only issue is price-sensitive buyback, which may change in 2026 or lead to higher specials. OCBC is in the middle of the pack ([link](#)), as we expect the incoming CEO to focus on RoA/growth rather than capital management upfront. We would look to add the stock on dips, but book gains above fair multiples. For UOB, we prefer to trim on rallies. Key upside risk for UOB comes from consistent buybacks, as well as capital rebuild in 4Q25.

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

See page 15 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

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▼ Underweight

Previous: Neutral

UOBH.SI, UOB SP

Price (23 Jan 26): S\$39.50

Price Target (Dec-26): S\$34.00

APAC Banks

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Quarterly Forecasts (FYE Dec)

Adj. EPS (\$)

	2024A	2025E	2026E
Q1	0.87	0.88A	0.79
Q2	0.84	0.79A	0.80
Q3	0.95	0.25A	0.84
Q4	0.90	0.82	0.88
FY	3.56	2.74	3.31

Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current	Hist %Rank (1=Top)			
	%Rank	6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	1	1	1	1	10
Growth	52	16	19	22	22
Momentum	76	82	28	31	31
Quality	19	16	16	22	7
Low Vol	22	22	7	25	4
ESGQ	29	18	85	94	87

Price Performance



	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	12.7%	12.9%	13.9%	5.8%
Rel	7.4%	7.4%	3.2%	-22.7%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	1,652
52-week range (\$\$)	39.50-28.59
Market cap (\$ mn)	50,927
Exchange rate	1.28
Free float (%)	86.0%
3M ADV (mn)	3.01
3M ADV (\$ mn)	81.8
Volatility (90 Day)	12
Index	FTSTI
BBG ANR (Buy Hold Sell)	7 10 0

Key Metrics (FYE Dec)

\$S in millions	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Financial Estimates				
Net interest income	9,674	9,286	9,200	9,689
Non interest income	4,620	4,662	4,880	5,112
Operating expenses	(6,074)	(6,153)	(6,276)	(6,402)
Adj. PPOP	8,220	7,794	7,804	8,399
Provision for loan losses	(873)	(2,205)	(1,217)	(1,169)
Adj. PBT	7,199	5,639	6,678	7,325
Adj. net income	5,946	4,560	5,431	5,967
Adj. EPS	3.56	2.74	3.31	3.69
BBG EPS	3.59	2.84	3.44	3.69
DPS	2.05	1.83	1.66	1.84
Loans	333,930	350,850	363,460	383,872
Deposits	403,978	427,862	452,525	476,387
Total Assets	537,664	563,159	595,866	628,317
Margins and Growth				
NIM	2.0%	1.9%	1.8%	1.8%
Ratios				
Loan/ Deposit ratio	82.7%	82.0%	80.3%	80.6%
NPL / Loans	1.5%	1.6%	1.7%	1.8%
Coverage	75.5%	83.2%	83.8%	85.5%
CET 1	15.5%	14.3%	14.0%	14.0%
Non-int. income/ Income	32.3%	33.4%	34.7%	34.5%
Cost/Income	42.5%	44.1%	44.6%	43.3%
LLP/Loans	(0.3%)	(0.6%)	(0.3%)	(0.3%)
ROA	1.1%	0.8%	0.9%	1.0%
ROE	13.1%	9.7%	11.3%	11.9%
Valuation				
Dividend yield	5.2%	4.6%	4.2%	4.7%
Adj. P/E	11.1	14.4	11.9	10.7
P/ BV	1.41	1.39	1.32	1.24

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

Investment Thesis

We are UW on UOB.

- The bank has lagged peers on WM (limited organic and inorganic build in last 15Y), as well on USD-denominated payment/deposits (26% at UOB vs. 38%/34% at DBS/OCBC). These factors, amongst others, likely led the bank to take too much risk in areas linked to property in Asia and the US over the last decade in a bid to generate better returns. Accordingly, we are now witnessing an increase in credit risks. The timing of gross NPL formation, recoveries and upgrades, as well as evolution of collateral values should lead to volatility on credit costs and expectations thereof.
- The bank has committed to a 50% payout ratio for regular dividends. Hence, as EPS risk increases, DPS will be at risk as well. This could limit the upside for the stock.
- UOB is close to 5Y highs on fwd PB/PE, ~1.5-2SD above mean. Yet, we expect ROE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25. We expect the stock to offer more balanced risk-return trade-off closer to mean of 1-1.1 fwd PB; which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$34 is based on a fair P/B of 1.08x with a normalized RoE of 11.5%, a risk-free rate of 4.15%, a cost of capital of 11% and a growth rate of 4.1%.

Performance Drivers

Market	25%
Region	22%
Macro	24%
Style	6%
Idiosyn.	23%

Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI Asia Pac ex JP	0.58	0.64
Region: Singapore	0.40	0.68
Macro:		
Emerging Economies CPI(YoY)	-0.17	0.31
HSI Volatility Index	-0.10	-0.28
JP Morgan EMBI Global Spread	0.21	-0.25
Quant Styles:		
Value	0.12	0.24
Momentum	-0.27	-0.15
DivYld	0.05	0.15

Source: J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy for Performance Drivers; company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan estimates for all other tables. Note: Price history may not be complete or exact.

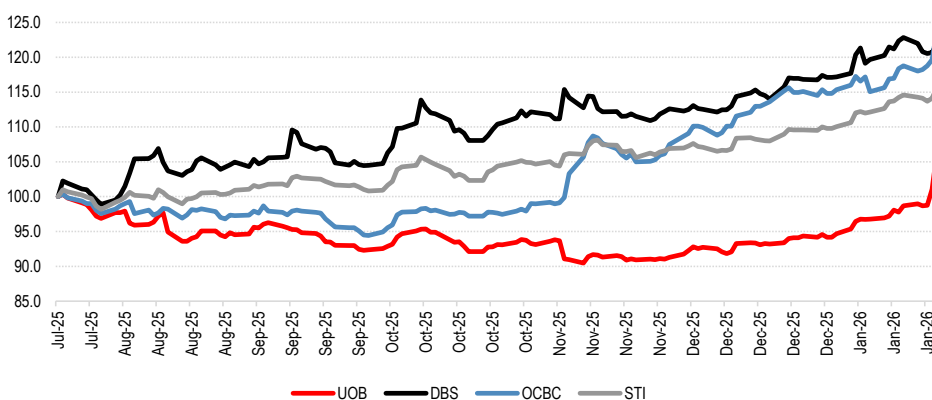
Downgrading UOB to UW post stock price strength

UOB is up 13% YTD vs. 4/8/5% for DBS, OCBC and STI. The rally came on the back of expectations of q/q improvement in 4Q; post a spike in provisions in 3Q. We broadly concurred with the short-term view, which along with low valuations led us to upgrade the stock in Nov-25 ([link](#)). Yet, we do not see AQ issues fully cleared in 4Q25, even if the quarter appears closer to BAU. Accordingly, we expect negative consensus revisions in 2026 (JPME is 4% below the street), leading to de-rating of the stock. The key risks stem from the HK CRE portfolio, as well as consistent high credit costs in TH; as has been the 2026 guidance from large TH banks last week. US CRE risk as well as tighter liquidity in Indonesia are further potential drivers of earnings risk. We are not changing our estimates and PT. Our pecking order in the industry now is DBS (OW) > OCBC (N) > UOB (UW).

The YTD rally opens up downside

Figure 1: UOB: 6M performance

rebased to 100



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Note: Past performance is not an indicator of future results.

Expect 2%/4% downside vs. Street on FY25/26E EPS

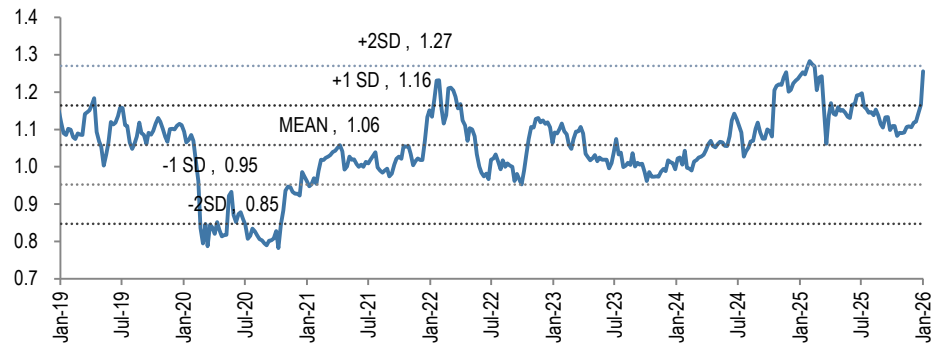
Table 1: Singapore banks: JPM vs street

EPS	EPSg y/y			JPM vs Street		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
DBS	-1%	0%	7%	0%	-1%	0%
OCBC	-4%	-1%	7%	-2%	-4%	-2%
UOB	-23%	21%	11%	-2%	-4%	0%
Average	-4%	7%	8%	0%	-1%	1%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

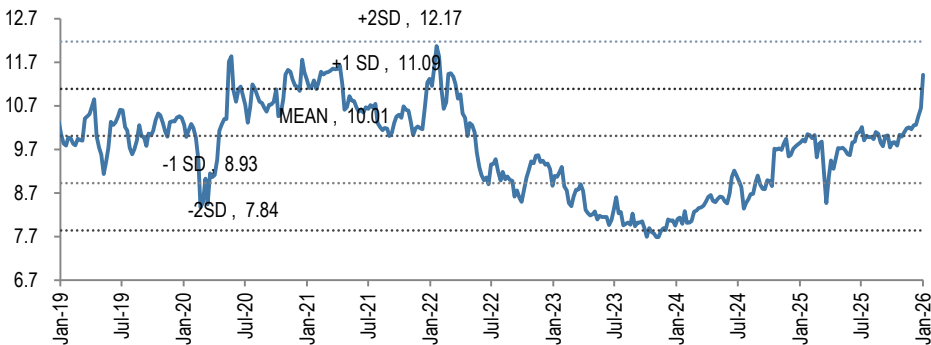
The stock has moved close to 2SD above mean PB

Figure 2: UOB: 12M Fwd PB



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

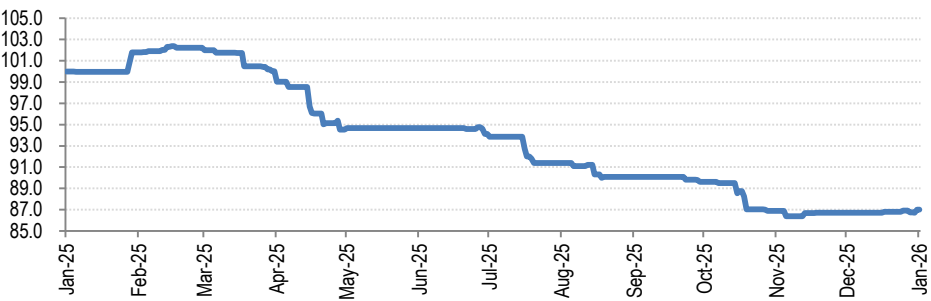
Figure 3: UOB: 12M Fwd PE



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Expecting risk of further negative EPS revisions

Figure 4: UOB: 2026 EPS revision



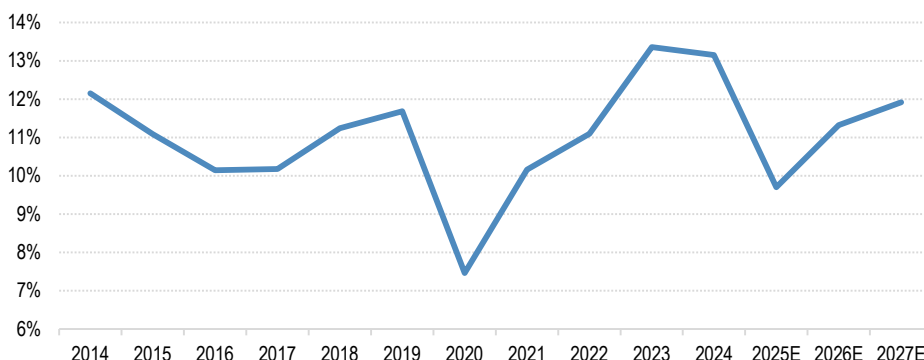
Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Risk-reward turns negative as valuations move up, ROEs stall

UOB is close to 5Y highs on fwd PB/PE at 1.3x/11.9x, ~1.5-2SD above mean. Yet, we expect ROE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25, when the PB had moved to ~1.3x. If anything, risks to 1H26 RoEs are high, as lower credit costs are not necessarily a given. The timing of gross NPL formation, recoveries and upgrades, as well as evolution of collateral values should lead to volatility in credit costs and expectations thereof. Moreover, at any point if the LLR/loans drops below 1%, de-rating will follow as investors will price in higher provisions going forward. We see a more balanced risk-return trade-off closer to 1-1.1 fwd PB (mean); which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.

Expect ROEs to normalize to 11-12%, but below 2023-24 peaks

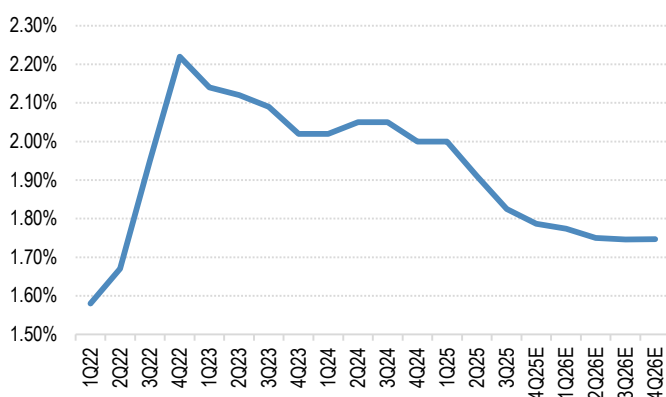
Figure 5: UOB: ROE trend



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

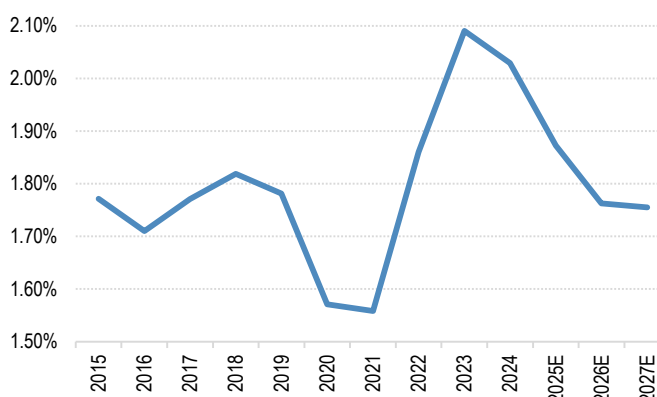
Declining NIM is a further drag to ROE, though the pace of decline could slow in line with USD/SGD rates.

Figure 6: UOB: Quarterly NIM



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 7: UOB: Annual NIM



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Asset quality may continue to see risks

Gross NPA formation in 3Q25 was S\$838mn (97bps, ann) vs. S\$400mn avg in previous 4Qs (47bps, ann). Net NPA formation in 3Q25 was S\$423mn (49bps, ann) vs. S\$109mn avg in previous 4Qs (13bps, ann). This recognition of higher gross NPA and accelerated upgrades, recoveries and write-offs are based on the bank's best estimate of economic risks as of 3Q. Looking at details, GC NPAs are up S\$508mn y/y (+51% y/y), led mostly by HK CRE; and RoW NPAs are up S\$469mn y/y (+105% y/y), led by US CRE.

On HK CRE, our colleagues (Karl Chan and team) have an informative deep dive ([here](#)). Key points include a smaller decline in office rents likely in 2026, but for older buildings in decentralized locations to face pressure, with quite a bit of sub-regional differences. Retail vacancy should continue to move up, and rentals lower. These trends do not bode well for UOB credit costs.

Figure 8: Gross NPL formation

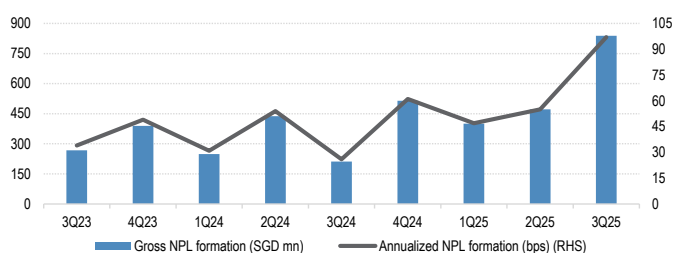
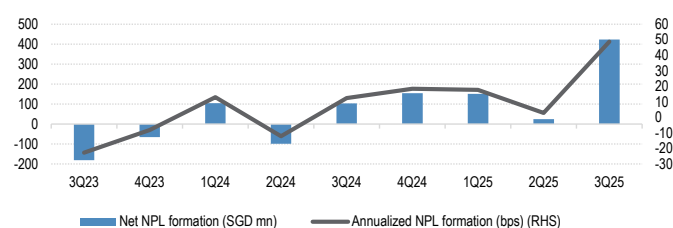
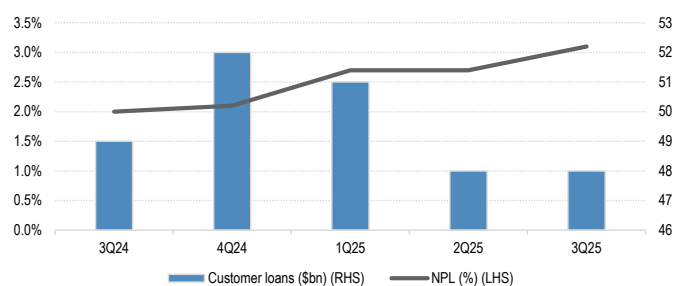


Figure 9: Net NPL formation



Source: Company reports.

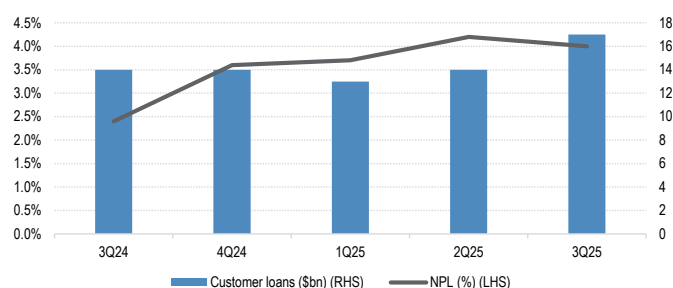
Figure 10: Greater China NPL ratio trend



Source: Company reports.

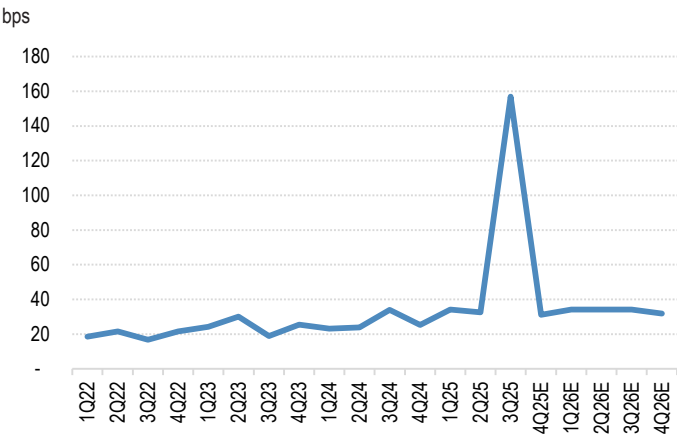
Source: Company reports.

Figure 11: US NPL ratio trend



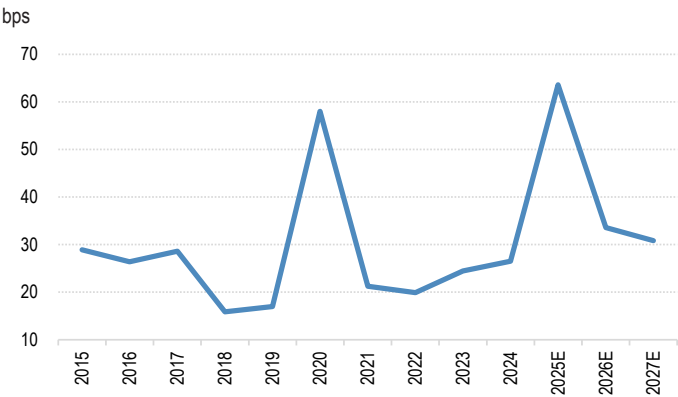
Source: Company reports.

Figure 12: UOB: Quarterly Credit Cost Trend



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

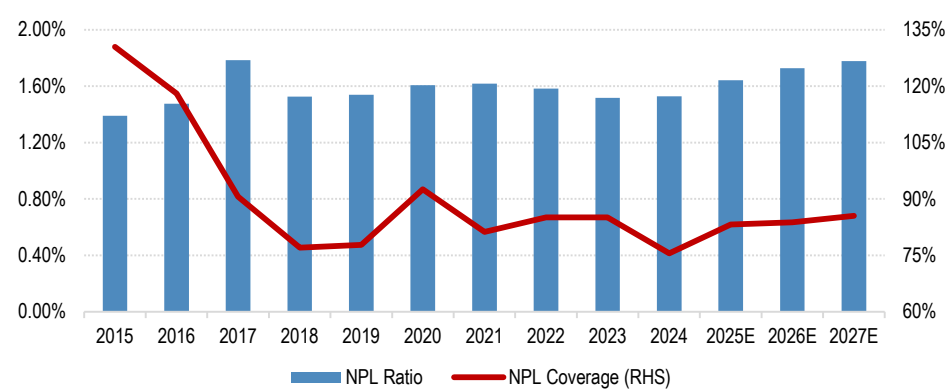
Figure 13: UOB: Annual Credit Cost Trend



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Any decline in NPL coverage or GP/performing loans could lead to higher credit costs.

Figure 14: UOB: NPL Ratio and NPL Coverage



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Capital management to drive differentiation across SG banks

Capital generation and distribution should drive differentiation across SG banks; with consistent flows (led by S\$ appeal and WM) leading to a positive bias. Yet, dividend yield as a factor will not be as dominant as the last 2Y. Expect EPS and DPS revisions, USD/SGD rate moves, AQ and buybacks to drive performance in 2026. Hence, we expect a year with a wider range of stock price moves.

DBS stays our top pick on high visibility on capital generation (highest RoE even after a 310bps SORA decline from the peak), led by WM, tech-led franchise, RoRWA focus and capital management. The only issue is price-sensitive buyback, which may change in 2026 or lead to higher specials. OCBC is in the middle of the pack ([link](#)), as we expect the incoming CEO to focus on RoA/growth rather than capital management upfront. We would look to add the stock on dips, but book gains above fair multiples. For UOB, we prefer to trim on rallies. Key upside risk for UOB comes from consistent buybacks, as well as capital rebuild in 4Q25.

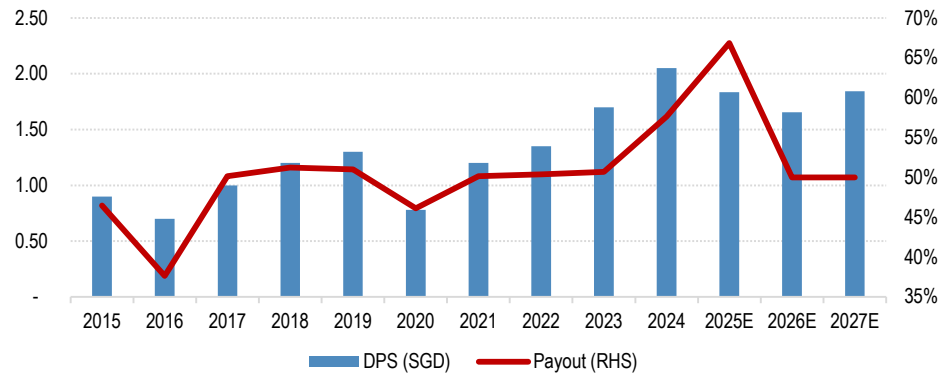
Table 2: Singapore banks: Total yield

SG Banks yields	DBS			OCBC			UOB		
	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E	2025E	2026E	2027E
Regular DPS	2.46	2.70	2.88	0.81	0.81	0.86	1.58	1.66	1.84
Special DPS	0.60	0.60	0.60	0.20	0.20	0.15	0.25	-	-
Total DPS	3.06	3.30	3.48	1.01	1.01	1.01	1.83	1.66	1.84
Yield									
Regular	4.2%	4.6%	4.9%	3.8%	3.8%	4.1%	4.0%	4.2%	4.7%
Special	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%	0.7%	0.6%	0.0%	0.0%
Total	5.2%	5.6%	5.9%	4.7%	4.7%	4.7%	4.6%	4.2%	4.7%
Payout									
Regular payout	63%	68%	68%	50%	50%	50%	58%	50%	50%
Regular + special payout	78%	83%	82%	63%	63%	58%	67%	50%	50%
Regular + special + buyback payout	82%	97%	94%	67%	70%	65%	80%	62%	61%
Total buyback (\$\$ mn)	450	1,500	1,500	370	630	600	700	750	750
Buyback amt. per share	0.16	0.54	0.54	0.08	0.14	0.14	0.42	0.46	0.46
Yield on buyback	0.3%	0.9%	0.9%	0.4%	0.7%	0.6%	1.1%	1.2%	1.2%
Total yields	5.5%	6.5%	6.9%	5.1%	5.4%	5.4%	5.7%	5.3%	5.8%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

UOB DPS could decline in FY26

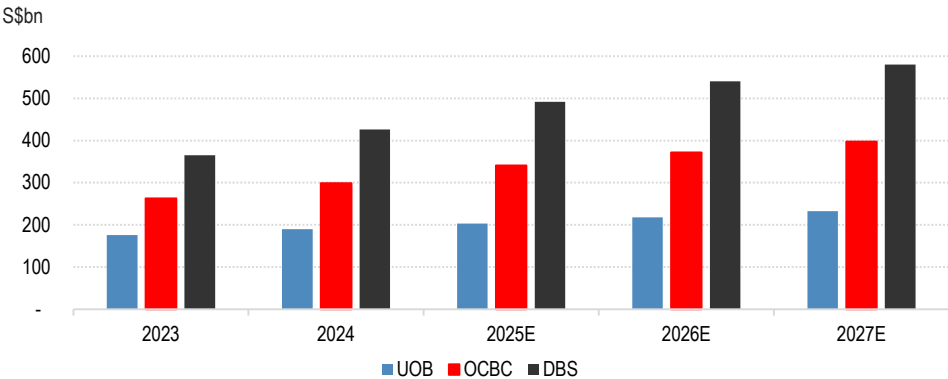
Figure 15: UOB: DPS and Dividend Payout



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

DBS and OCBC lead in wealth management, benefiting from flows into SG

Figure 16: Singapore Banks: AuM trends



Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Valuation

Table 3: UOB: Valuation

	Net Inc (S\$ mn)	EPS (S\$)	P/E (x)	BVPS (S\$)	P/B (x)	Dividend (S\$)	Div Yld (%)	RoA (%)	RoRWA (%)	RoE (%)
2020	2,825	1.69	23.4	23.0	1.72	0.78	2.0%	0.68%	1.25%	7.5%
2021	4,003	2.39	16.5	24.1	1.64	1.20	3.0%	0.90%	1.65%	10.2%
2022	4,485	2.68	14.7	24.2	1.63	1.35	3.4%	0.98%	1.73%	11.7%
2023	5,615	3.36	11.8	26.0	1.52	1.70	4.3%	1.16%	2.10%	14.2%
2024	5,946	3.56	11.1	28.1	1.41	2.05	5.2%	1.16%	2.22%	13.6%
2025E	4,560	2.74	14.4	28.5	1.39	1.83	4.6%	0.83%	1.68%	9.7%
2026E	5,431	3.31	11.9	30.0	1.32	1.66	4.2%	0.94%	1.86%	11.3%
2027E	5,967	3.69	10.7	31.9	1.24	1.84	4.7%	0.97%	1.93%	11.9%
	Price (S\$)	39.50	Number of shares (mn)			1,663	Market Cap (S\$ mn)			65,703
Normalised RoE			PB based Valuation				PE based Valuation			
NIM (on avg. assets)	1.62%		Risk-free rate				4.15%	Fair PE		9.38x
Non-IR/revenues	34.2%		Cost of capital				11.0%	12m Rolling EPS		S\$3.35
Cost/income	44.0%		Long term growth				4.10%	PE based 12M Fwd Fair Value		S\$31.4
Operating RoA	1.38%		Fair PB				1.08x	Implied Value of Growth		
LLP/Loans	-0.35%		PV of Terminal Value				S\$29.3	12m Rolling EPS		S\$3.35
Net RoAA	0.95%		PV of Dividends				S\$1.5	Capitalized Value (S\$)		\$30.53
Equity/Assets	8.3%		PV of today's Fair Value				S\$30.8	Value of Growth (S\$)		\$8.97
Normalised RoE	11.5%		PV of Dec-26E fair value				S\$34.2	Attributable to Growth		22.7%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates.

Annual forecasts

Table 4: UOB: Annual P&L

\$S in million	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
Interest Income	7,826	8,291	9,077	11,141	12,557	9,623	8,204	12,862	22,242	23,259	20,239	18,593	18,940
Interest Expense	(2,900)	(3,300)	(3,548)	(4,921)	(5,994)	(3,587)	(1,816)	(4,519)	(12,563)	(13,585)	(10,953)	(9,393)	(9,251)
Net Interest Income	4,926	4,991	5,528	6,220	6,563	6,036	6,388	8,343	9,679	9,674	9,286	9,200	9,689
Non-Interest Income	3,122	3,071	3,323	2,896	3,467	3,141	3,401	3,232	4,253	4,620	4,662	4,880	5,112
Net Fee income	1,883	1,931	2,161	1,966	2,032	1,997	2,412	2,143	2,235	2,395	2,551	2,704	2,866
Trading income	954	877	902	648	1,116	880	730	829	1,690	2,003	1,823	1,859	1,896
Other operating income	285	263	260	282	319	264	259	260	328	222	289	317	349
Total Revenues	8,048	8,061	8,851	9,116	10,030	9,177	9,789	11,575	13,932	14,294	13,948	14,080	14,801
Costs	(3,530)	(3,696)	(4,027)	(4,003)	(4,472)	(4,184)	(4,313)	(5,016)	(5,777)	(6,074)	(6,153)	(6,276)	(6,402)
PPOP	4,518	4,365	4,824	5,113	5,558	4,992	5,476	6,559	8,155	8,220	7,794	7,804	8,399
Loan loss provisions	(588)	(571)	(660)	(395)	(450)	(1,595)	(629)	(627)	(784)	(873)	(2,205)	(1,217)	(1,169)
Other provisions	(84)	(23)	(67)	2	15	42	(28)	21	(161)	(81)	(23)	-	-
Other income	90	6	110	106	51	98	118	97	93	121	73	91	95
Pre-Tax	3,936	3,777	4,207	4,826	5,174	3,536	4,937	6,050	7,303	7,387	5,639	6,678	7,325
Tax	(649)	(669)	(800)	(805)	(813)	(606)	(850)	(1,221)	(1,228)	(1,140)	(970)	(1,135)	(1,245)
MI & EO	(11)	(12)	(16)	(13)	(18)	(15)	(12)	(10)	(14)	(14)	(11)	(13)	(14)
Core Profit	3,276	3,096	3,390	4,008	4,343	2,915	4,075	4,819	6,061	6,233	4,658	5,530	6,066
Attributable profits	3,170	3,012	3,288	3,898	4,249	2,825	4,003	4,731	5,965	6,134	4,560	5,431	5,967
EPS	1.94	1.86	1.99	2.34	2.55	1.69	2.39	2.68	3.36	3.56	2.74	3.31	3.69
DPS	0.90	0.70	1.00	1.20	1.30	0.78	1.20	1.35	1.70	2.05	1.83	1.66	1.84
Payout	46%	38%	50%	51%	51%	46%	50%	50%	51%	58%	67%	50%	50%

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Table 5: UOB: Annual Dupont

	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
NIM (% of avg. IEA)	1.77%	1.71%	1.77%	1.82%	1.78%	1.57%	1.56%	1.86%	2.09%	2.03%	1.87%	1.76%	1.76%
IEA/Assets	89.3%	89.0%	89.4%	91.6%	93.0%	91.9%	92.0%	93.1%	90.1%	89.8%	90.1%	90.1%	90.2%
Margins (% of avg. Assets)	1.58%	1.52%	1.58%	1.67%	1.66%	1.44%	1.43%	1.73%	1.88%	1.82%	1.69%	1.59%	1.58%
Non-IR contribution	38.8%	38.1%	37.5%	31.8%	34.6%	34.2%	34.7%	27.9%	30.5%	32.3%	33.4%	34.7%	34.5%
Non-IR/Avg. Assets	1.00%	0.94%	0.95%	0.78%	0.87%	0.75%	0.76%	0.67%	0.83%	0.87%	0.85%	0.84%	0.84%
Revenue/Assets	2.58%	2.46%	2.53%	2.44%	2.53%	2.19%	2.20%	2.40%	2.71%	2.69%	2.53%	2.43%	2.42%
Cost/Income	43.9%	45.9%	45.5%	43.9%	44.6%	45.6%	44.1%	43.3%	41.5%	42.5%	44.1%	44.6%	43.3%
C/Assets	1.13%	1.13%	1.15%	1.07%	1.13%	1.00%	0.97%	1.04%	1.12%	1.14%	1.12%	1.08%	1.05%
Pre-Provision ROA	1.45%	1.33%	1.38%	1.37%	1.40%	1.19%	1.23%	1.36%	1.59%	1.55%	1.42%	1.35%	1.37%
LLP/Loans	-0.3%	-0.3%	-0.29%	-0.16%	-0.17%	-0.58%	-0.21%	-0.20%	-0.24%	-0.26%	-0.64%	-0.34%	-0.31%
Loan/Assets	65.3%	66.0%	66.1%	66.7%	66.9%	65.8%	66.5%	65.4%	62.3%	62.1%	63.0%	62.5%	62.0%
Other Income/Assets	0.00%	-0.01%	0.01%	0.03%	0.02%	0.03%	0.02%	0.02%	-0.01%	0.01%	0.01%	0.02%	0.02%
Operating ROA	1.26%	1.16%	1.19%	1.26%	1.29%	0.81%	1.09%	1.23%	1.43%	1.38%	1.02%	1.14%	1.18%
Pre-Tax ROA	1.26%	1.15%	1.20%	1.29%	1.31%	0.85%	1.11%	1.26%	1.42%	1.39%	1.02%	1.15%	1.20%
Tax Rate	-16.5%	-17.7%	-19.0%	-16.7%	-15.7%	-17.1%	-17.2%	-20.2%	-16.8%	-15.4%	-17.2%	-17.0%	-17.0%
Minorities & Outside Int.	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Core ROA	1.02%	0.92%	0.94%	1.04%	1.07%	0.68%	0.90%	0.98%	1.16%	1.16%	0.83%	0.94%	0.97%
ROA	1.00%	0.92%	0.94%	1.04%	1.07%	0.68%	0.90%	0.93%	1.09%	1.12%	0.83%	0.94%	0.97%
RoRWA	1.64%	1.45%	1.58%	1.86%	1.90%	1.25%	1.65%	1.73%	2.10%	2.22%	1.68%	1.86%	1.93%
Equity/Assets	8.99%	9.05%	9.25%	9.29%	9.18%	9.06%	8.84%	8.39%	8.18%	8.52%	8.54%	8.28%	8.18%
Core ROE	11.3%	10.1%	10.2%	11.2%	11.7%	7.5%	10.2%	11.7%	14.2%	13.6%	9.7%	11.3%	11.9%
ROE	11.1%	10.1%	10.2%	11.2%	11.7%	7.5%	10.2%	11.1%	13.4%	13.1%	9.7%	11.3%	11.9%

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Quarterly forecasts

Table 6: UOB: Quarterly P&L

\$S in million	3Q23	4Q23	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25E	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Interest Income	5,692	5,947	5,855	5,706	5,791	5,907	5,630	5,042	4,802	4,766	4,665	4,600	4,650	4,679
Interest Expense	(3,263)	(3,543)	(3,493)	(3,305)	(3,331)	(3,456)	(3,221)	(2,706)	(2,537)	(2,490)	(2,420)	(2,329)	(2,325)	(2,318)
Net Interest Income	2,429	2,404	2,362	2,401	2,460	2,451	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,276	2,245	2,271	2,324	2,361
Non-Interest Income	1,027	1,007	1,161	1,075	1,374	1,010	1,248	1,129	1,133	1,152	1,190	1,213	1,249	1,229
Net Fee income	591	568	580	618	630	567	694	636	615	606	684	664	684	672
Trading income	375	363	521	406	709	367	466	414	479	464	427	469	483	480
Other operating income	61	76	60	51	35	76	88	79	39	83	78	80	82	77
Total Revenues	3,456	3,411	3,523	3,476	3,834	3,461	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,428	3,434	3,484	3,573	3,590
Costs	(1,416)	(1,473)	(1,475)	(1,452)	(1,590)	(1,558)	(1,559)	(1,535)	(1,535)	(1,524)	(1,539)	(1,571)	(1,595)	(1,572)
PPOP	2,040	1,938	2,048	2,024	2,244	1,903	2,097	1,930	1,863	1,903	1,895	1,913	1,978	2,018
Loan loss provisions	(151)	(203)	(186)	(194)	(281)	(212)	(290)	(279)	(1,361)	(275)	(305)	(308)	(311)	(293)
Other provisions	(91)	44	16	(44)	(30)	(23)	(7)	(9)	(7)	0	0	0	0	0
Other income	20	22	26	30	25	40	22	(3)	25	29	23	24	24	20
Pre-Tax	1,818	1,801	1,904	1,816	1,958	1,708	1,822	1,639	520	1,657	1,613	1,629	1,691	1,745
Tax	(305)	(370)	(317)	(307)	(299)	(219)	(310)	(317)	(82)	(261)	(274)	(277)	(287)	(297)
MI & EO	(34)	67	(22)	(22)	(22)	51	(22)	16	5	(10)	(10)	(10)	(10)	16
Core Profit	1,479	1,498	1,566	1,488	1,638	1,540	1,490	1,338	443	1,386	1,330	1,342	1,394	1,464
Attributable profit	1,382	1,404	1,487	1,424	1,610	1,523	1,490	1,338	443	1,386	1,330	1,342	1,394	1,464
Preference dividends	33	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25	25
Core Profits for SHs	1,446	1,473	1,541	1,463	1,613	1,515	1,466	1,313	418	1,361	1,305	1,317	1,369	1,440
Profits for SHs	1,349	1,379	1,462	1,399	1,585	1,498	1,466	1,313	418	1,361	1,305	1,317	1,369	1,440
EPS	0.81	0.82	0.87	0.84	0.95	0.90	0.88	0.79	0.25	0.82	0.79	0.80	0.84	0.88
DPS	-	0.85	-	0.88	-	1.17	-	1.10	-	0.73	-	0.80	-	0.86

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Table 7: UOB: Quarterly Dupont

	3Q23	4Q23	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25E	1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
NIM (% of avg. IEA)	2.09%	2.02%	2.02%	2.05%	2.05%	2.00%	2.00%	1.91%	1.82%	1.79%	1.77%	1.75%	1.75%	1.75%
IEA/Assets	90.3%	90.9%	90.5%	91.3%	90.2%	90.3%	90.8%	91.2%	90.3%	90.4%	90.7%	90.7%	90.7%	90.7%
Margins (% of avg. Assets)	1.89%	1.84%	1.83%	1.87%	1.85%	1.81%	1.82%	1.74%	1.65%	1.61%	1.61%	1.59%	1.58%	1.59%
Non-IR contribution	29.7%	29.5%	33.0%	30.9%	35.8%	29.2%	34.1%	32.6%	33.3%	33.6%	34.6%	34.8%	35.0%	34.2%
Non-IR/Avg. Assets	0.80%	0.78%	0.89%	0.83%	1.04%	0.75%	0.93%	0.84%	0.83%	0.82%	0.84%	0.85%	0.86%	0.83%
Revenue/Assets	2.71%	2.63%	2.71%	2.69%	2.90%	2.56%	2.72%	2.58%	2.49%	2.45%	2.43%	2.43%	2.46%	2.43%
Cost/Income	41.0%	43.2%	41.9%	41.8%	41.5%	45.0%	42.6%	44.3%	45.2%	44.5%	44.8%	45.1%	44.6%	43.8%
C/Assets	1.11%	1.13%	1.14%	1.13%	1.20%	1.15%	1.16%	1.14%	1.12%	1.09%	1.09%	1.10%	1.10%	1.06%
Pre-Provision ROA	1.60%	1.49%	1.58%	1.57%	1.70%	1.41%	1.56%	1.44%	1.36%	1.36%	1.34%	1.33%	1.36%	1.37%
LLP/Loans	-0.19%	-0.25%	-0.23%	-0.24%	-0.34%	-0.25%	-0.34%	-0.33%	-1.57%	-0.31%	-0.34%	-0.34%	-0.34%	-0.32%
Loan/Assets	62.4%	61.5%	62.0%	63.0%	62.5%	62.2%	63.1%	63.6%	63.5%	63.2%	63.1%	62.9%	62.6%	62.2%
Operating ROA	1.48%	1.34%	1.43%	1.42%	1.48%	1.25%	1.34%	1.23%	0.37%	1.16%	1.12%	1.12%	1.15%	1.17%
Pre-Tax ROA	1.42%	1.39%	1.47%	1.41%	1.48%	1.27%	1.36%	1.22%	0.38%	1.18%	1.14%	1.14%	1.16%	1.18%
Tax Rate	-16.8%	-20.5%	-16.6%	-16.9%	-15.2%	-12.8%	-17.0%	-19.3%	-15.8%	-15.7%	-17.0%	-17.0%	-17.0%	-17.0%
Minorities & Outside Int.	-0.03%	0.05%	-0.02%	-0.02%	-0.02%	0.04%	-0.02%	0.01%	0.00%	-0.01%	-0.01%	-0.01%	-0.01%	0.01%
Core ROA	1.13%	1.13%	1.19%	1.13%	1.22%	1.12%	1.09%	0.98%	0.31%	0.97%	0.92%	0.92%	0.94%	0.97%
ROA	1.06%	1.06%	1.13%	1.08%	1.20%	1.11%	1.09%	0.98%	0.31%	0.97%	0.92%	0.92%	0.94%	0.97%
RoRWA	2.02%	2.02%	2.12%	2.00%	2.36%	2.34%	2.22%	1.96%	0.62%	1.96%	1.85%	1.84%	1.88%	1.94%
Equity/Assets	8.19%	8.19%	8.49%	8.66%	8.54%	8.60%	8.89%	8.95%	8.65%	8.41%	8.31%	8.29%	8.25%	8.19%
Core ROE	13.8%	13.9%	14.0%	13.1%	14.3%	13.1%	12.3%	10.9%	3.5%	11.6%	11.1%	11.1%	11.4%	11.9%
ROE	12.9%	13.0%	13.3%	12.5%	14.0%	12.9%	12.3%	10.9%	3.5%	11.6%	11.1%	11.1%	11.4%	11.9%

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

United Overseas Bank (UOB) *(Underweight; Price Target: S\$34.00)*

Investment Thesis

We are UW on UOB.

- UOB has delivered RoE with the least volatility among Singapore banks over the past 20 years. This may change over the next few quarters, as asset quality risks could remain elevated.
- The bank has lagged peers on WM (limited organic and inorganic build in last 15Y), as well on USD-denominated payment/deposits (26% at UOB vs. 38%/34% at DBS/OCBC). These factors, amongst others, likely led the bank to take too much risk in areas linked to property in Asia and the US over the last decade in a bid to generate better returns. Accordingly, we are now witnessing an increase in credit risks. The timing of gross NPL formation, recoveries and upgrades, as well as evolution of collateral values should lead to volatility on credit costs and expectations thereof.
- The bank has committed to a 50% payout ratio for regular dividends. Hence, as EPS risk increases, DPS will be at risk as well. This could limit the upside for the stock.
- UOB is close to 5Y highs on fwd PB/PE, ~1.5-2SD above mean. Yet, we expect ROE to be closer to 11% in 1H26 vs. 12-13% in 4Q24/1Q25. We expect the stock to offer more balanced risk-return trade-off closer to the mean of 1-1.1 fwd PB; which would price in a degree of lingering AQ risks.
- Following increased spend in last 2Y, the bank is better positioned to focus on efficiency, which could pose an upside risk.

Valuation

Our Dec-26 PT of S\$34 is based on a fair P/B of 1.08x with a normalized RoE of 11.5%, a risk-free rate of 4.15%, a cost of capital of 11% and a growth rate of 4.1%.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include better-than-expected delivery on AQ, with sustained normalization of NPA formation and credit costs. On PPoP, the bank's ability to manage wins from its digital investments could lead to positive revisions, and investments coming to fruition earlier than anticipated would pose upside risks to costs.

Downside catalysts include credit cost increases, growth and NIM disappointments, and lower-than-expected dividends and buybacks. Higher operating costs would also be a downside risk. Higher-than-anticipated digital investment spending could be a drag on profitability.

United Overseas Bank (UOB): Summary of Financials

Income Statement						Balance Sheet					
	FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E		FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Interest income	22,242	23,259	20,239	18,593	18,940	Cash and cash equivalents	0	0	0	0	0
Interest expense	(12,563)	(13,585)	(10,953)	(9,393)	(9,251)	Deposits with banks	87,443	76,009	66,725	72,013	76,336
Net interest income	9,679	9,674	9,286	9,200	9,689	Net loans	317,005	333,930	350,850	363,460	383,872
Non interest income	4,253	4,620	4,662	4,880	5,112	PP&E	4,508	4,852	5,240	5,502	5,722
o/w Fee income	2,235	2,395	2,551	2,704	2,866	Net intangibles	4,984	4,979	4,979	4,979	4,979
o/w Trading income	1,690	2,003	1,823	1,859	1,896	LT investments	90,339	96,625	111,119	124,453	130,676
Net revenues	13,932	14,294	13,948	14,080	14,801	Other assets	19,241	21,269	24,247	25,459	26,732
Non interest expense	(5,777)	(6,074)	(6,153)	(6,276)	(6,402)	Total assets	523,520	537,664	563,159	595,866	628,317
o/w Employee costs	(3,553)	(3,699)	(3,625)	(3,698)	(3,771)	Interest earning assets	498,932	510,465	533,555	565,267	596,810
Pre-Prov. Profits	8,155	8,220	7,794	7,804	8,399	Deposits	385,469	403,978	427,862	452,525	476,387
Provisions	(784)	(873)	(2,205)	(1,217)	(1,169)	Borrowings	68,651	61,102	59,246	63,911	68,458
Adj. PBT	6,953	7,199	5,639	6,678	7,325	Other liabilities	25,680	25,375	28,769	30,330	31,985
Income taxes	(1,228)	(1,140)	(970)	(1,135)	(1,245)	Total liabilities	479,800	490,455	515,876	546,766	576,830
Minority interest	(14)	(14)	(11)	(13)	(14)	Shareholder equity	43,478	46,985	47,059	48,877	51,263
Adj. Net profit	5,615	5,946	4,560	5,431	5,967	Minority interests	242	224	224	224	224
PPOP per share	4.87	4.92	4.69	4.76	5.19	Total liabilities and Shareholder equity	523,520	537,664	563,159	595,866	628,317
Reported EPS	3.36	3.56	2.74	3.31	3.69	Interest bearing liabilities	454,120	465,080	487,107	516,435	544,845
Adj. EPS	3.36	3.56	2.74	3.31	3.69	Book Value Per Share	26.00	28.11	28.49	29.99	31.87
DPS	1.70	2.05	1.83	1.66	1.84	Tangible Book Value Per Share	25.85	27.98	28.35	29.85	31.73
Diluted shares outstanding	1,674	1,672	1,662	1,641	1,619						
Balance Sheet Gearing	FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E	Asset Quality/Capital	FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Loans/Deposits	82.2%	82.7%	82.0%	80.3%	80.6%	Loan loss reserves/Loans	(1.3%)	(1.2%)	(1.4%)	(1.4%)	(1.5%)
Investment/Assets	15.9%	17.6%	18.9%	20.3%	20.8%	NPLs/Loans	1.5%	1.5%	1.6%	1.7%	1.8%
Loan/Assets	62.3%	62.1%	63.0%	62.5%	62.0%	Loan loss reserves/NPLs	85.1%	80.2%	79.6%	83.5%	84.7%
Customer deposits/Liabilities	80.3%	82.4%	82.9%	82.8%	82.6%	NPL y/y growth	(3.8%)	6.0%	13.1%	9.1%	8.7%
LT debt/Liabilities	14.2%	13.4%	12.0%	11.6%	11.8%	Tier 1 ratio	14.4%	16.6%	14.3%	14.0%	14.0%
						CAR	16.6%	18.2%	15.9%	15.5%	15.4%
Ratio Analysis (%)	FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E	Ratio Analysis (%)	FY23A	FY24A	FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Net interest margin	2.1%	2.0%	1.9%	1.8%	1.8%	Return on equity (ROE)	13.4%	13.1%	9.7%	11.3%	11.9%
Non interest income/Net revenue	30.5%	32.3%	33.4%	34.7%	34.5%	Return on assets (ROA)	1.1%	1.1%	0.8%	0.9%	1.0%
Non interest income/Avg. Assets	0.8%	0.9%	0.8%	0.8%	0.8%	Operating ROA	1.4%	1.4%	1.0%	1.1%	1.2%
Efficiency ratio	41.5%	42.5%	44.1%	44.6%	43.3%	Pre-Tax ROA	1.4%	1.4%	1.0%	1.2%	1.2%
Leverage ratio	7.8%	8.1%	7.3%	7.3%	7.3%	Pre-Provision ROA	1.6%	1.5%	1.4%	1.3%	1.4%
Revenue/Assets	2.7%	2.7%	2.5%	2.4%	2.4%	Tax rate	17.7%	15.8%	17.2%	17.0%	17.0%
RORWA	2.1%	2.2%	1.7%	1.9%	1.9%						
RWA	275,930	259,835	281,580	300,913	317,300	Net loans y/y growth	0.5%	5.3%	5.1%	3.6%	5.6%
Avg. RWA	267,514	267,883	270,707	291,246	309,106	Assets y/y growth	3.8%	2.7%	4.7%	5.8%	5.4%
Avg. IEA	462,994	476,735	495,910	521,940	551,986	RWA y/y growth	6.5%	(5.8%)	8.4%	6.9%	5.4%
Gross Loans	321,150	337,831	355,711	368,801	389,798	Deposits y/y growth	4.6%	4.8%	5.9%	5.8%	5.3%
Avg. IBL	434,135	434,135	449,715	473,970	501,239	Net interest income y/y growth	16.0%	(0.1%)	(4.0%)	(0.9%)	5.3%
LLR	(4,145)	(3,901)	(4,861)	(5,341)	(5,926)	Revenues y/y growth	20.4%	2.6%	(2.4%)	0.9%	5.1%
NPLs	4,870	5,164	5,840	6,373	6,926	Adj. EPS y/y growth	25.2%	6.0%	(22.8%)	20.6%	11.3%
P/BV (x)	1.52	1.41	1.39	1.32	1.24	BVPS y/y growth	7.3%	8.1%	1.4%	5.3%	6.3%
Adj. P/E (x)	11.8	11.1	14.4	11.9	10.7	IE assets/Assets	90.1%	89.8%	90.1%	90.1%	90.2%
Dividend yield	4.3%	5.2%	4.6%	4.2%	4.7%	Margins (as % of Avg. Assets)	1.8%	1.7%	1.6%	1.5%	1.5%
Dividend payout	50.7%	57.6%	66.9%	50.0%	50.0%	LLP/Loans	(0.2%)	(0.3%)	(0.6%)	(0.3%)	(0.3%)
						Equity/Assets	8.2%	8.5%	8.5%	8.3%	8.2%
						Cost/Assets	1.1%	1.1%	1.1%	1.1%	1.0%
						Assets/Equity	12.2	11.7	11.7	12.1	12.2

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Note: \$ in millions (except per-share data). Fiscal year ends Dec

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 23 January 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

DBS Group Holdings(DBSM.SI/\$58.65/OW), OCBC Bank(OCBC.SI/\$21.29/N)

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United Overseas Bank (UOB) (UOBH.SI, UOB SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
30-Mar-23	N	29.95	28.5
05-Oct-23	N	28.07	28
09-Dec-23	N	27.58	27
13-Mar-24	N	28.28	30
03-Jul-24	N	31.65	32.5
06-Oct-24	N	31.86	34
10-Nov-24	OW	35.69	41
14-Jan-25	OW	36.80	43
23-Mar-25	N	37.95	40
21-May-25	N	35.40	37
13-Jul-25	N	36.86	38
08-Aug-25	N	35.81	36.5
10-Sep-25	UW	35.57	32.5
28-Nov-25	N	33.89	34

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Sep 24, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

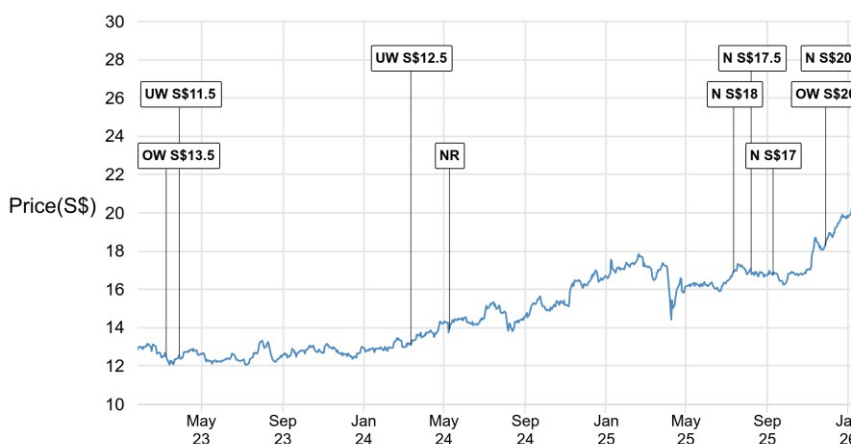
DBS Group Holdings (DBSM.SI, DBS SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	N	30.64	31
30-Mar-23	UW	30.54	27
05-Oct-23	UW	30.20	28
09-Dec-23	UW	28.73	27.5
13-Mar-24	N	30.46	30
03-Jul-24	OW	37.10	41
06-Oct-24	OW	38.04	42
10-Nov-24	OW	42.40	50
11-Feb-25	OW	45.38	51
23-Mar-25	OW	45.31	49
21-May-25	N	44.38	47
13-Jul-25	N	45.99	48
08-Aug-25	N	49.75	50.5
10-Sep-25	OW	50.88	56
28-Nov-25	OW	54.00	70

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 11, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

OCBC Bank (OCBC.SI, OCBC SP) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
09-Mar-23	OW	12.55	13.5
30-Mar-23	UW	12.53	11.5
13-Mar-24	UW	13.09	12.5
10-May-24	NR	13.91	--
13-Jul-25	N	16.89	18
08-Aug-25	N	17.09	17.5
10-Sep-25	N	16.76	17
28-Nov-25	OW	18.27	20
09-Jan-26	N	20.17	20.5

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